Nationality Designation of Classes of Persons

H 350

A. Background 1

B. Recent revisions 1

C. General rule 2

D. Other types of qualifiers 2

E. National qualifiers for classes of authors 3

F. National qualifiers for students 3

Revision history 3

A. Background

It was formerly Library of Congress practice to modify the headings for individual classes of persons as follows:

Modification	**Example**	**Purpose**
Geographic subdivision	Engineers--United States	Designate location
Adjectival qualifier	Engineers, American	Designate nationality
Combination of the above	Engineers, American--France	Designate both nationality and location

Although in theory each heading created by means of the geographical subdivision or qualifier should have been unique and significant, in actual practice this was not the case. The resources entered under the heading with the geographic subdivision frequently represented contents identical to those under the heading with the adjectival qualifier. In addition, catalog users encountered difficulty in understanding the distinctions that were intended. It was therefore decided in 1973 to combine the files where possible.

B. Recent revisions

2026-05: Updated template. Added instructions in section D.

C. General rule

Do not use adjectival qualifiers that represent jurisdictions or geographic regions in connection with classes of persons. Use geographic subdivision instead.

Examples:

650 #0 $a Engineers $z United States.

[not 650 #0 $a Engineers, American.]

650 #0 $a Engineers $z Europe.

[not 650 #0 $a Engineers, European.]

Use geographic subdivision to mean either "currently in" or "originally from." For example, use the combination of the following two headings to designate American engineers in France:

650 #0 $a Engineers $z France.

650 #0 $a Engineers $z United States.

Exception: This policy does not extend to persons associated with the field of *belles-lettres*, nor to headings of the type ***[. . .] students***. For qualified headings in these categories, see sections E-F, below.

D. Other types of qualifiers

The provision above does not apply to other types of qualifiers. Use at most one or two adjectival qualifiers with classes of persons to designate ethnic group, religion, sex, etc., and divide these headings geographically if appropriate.

In general, headings established with three or more qualifiers may be too narrowly focused and of limited utility. Instead assign a combination of headings to represent specific classes of persons.

Example:

650 #0 $a Italian American women.

650 #0 $a High school teachers.

[not 650 #0 $a Italian American women high school teachers.]

See H 306, H 320, and H 351, section 2, for instructions on establishing headings in inverted or direct form.

Examples:

Muslim students (May Subd Geog)

African American scientists (May Subd Geog)

Women scientists (May Subd Geog)

Women, Māori (May Subd Geog)

E. National qualifiers for classes of authors

Use adjectival qualifiers for the various categories of literary authors, such as ***Poets***, ***Dramatists***, ***Humorists***, etc., since they may designate not only nationality but also language. Divide these headings geographically if appropriate.

Example:

650 #0 $a Poets, English $z France.

The adjectival qualifier for headings of the type ***[class of authors], [nationality]*** or ***[class of authors], [ethnic group]*** is not added to the heading on a free-floating basis; establish each heading editorially as needed.

F. National qualifiers for students

Use adjectival qualifiers for students of various countries studying in other countries. Establish these heading in uninverted form and authorize them to be geographically divided.

Examples:

American students (May Subd Geog)

Chinese students (May Subd Geog)

To works about students in their own countries, assign the heading ***Students--[place]***.

Revision history

2026-05: Updated template. Added instructions in section D.